

c. 1937, June

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

#### CAPUCHIN-FRANCISCAN APPRECIATION

Good after-noon my Brethren.

Holy Job tells us, "the life of man on earth is a warfare". He makes no exceptions. The Psalmist appeals to us all without exception: "Be ye converted to the Lord your God." and in another place "O Lord God of hosts convert us: and show thy face, and we shall be saved." (Ps. 79-20) A Christian poet whispers to us as a loving brother:

"Poor wanderers of a stormy day

"From wave to wave we're drive:

And fancy's flash and reason's ray serve but to light  
the troubled way,

"There's nothing calm but Heaven.

Moore

More encouraging than all--for those who realize their weakness--Jesus Christ, the long promised Messiah our Redeemer, assures us: "I am come to call sinners ...."

In the light of Christian reasoning, therefore, brightened by these and similar expressions, I presume to address this audience as my brothers and my sisters; and under present circumstances, on the subject of Capuchin-Franciscan Appreciation.

One of the outstanding prayers of all history, with consequent approval of Heaven, was the prayer of King Solomon for wisdom to discern between good and evil--for wisdom to judge justly.

"And the Lord said to Solomon: Because thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thyself long life or riches, nor for the lives of thy enemies, but hast asked for thyself wisdom to discern judgement, Behold I have done for thee according to thy words, and have given thee a wise and understanding heart, insomuch that there hath been no one like thee before thee...."

In the light of the enthusiasm on the part of our neighbors and friends--our contemporaries without distinction of creed or color--it is a privilege of our Capuchin Community, in whose name these few words are spoken, to express something of the appreciation that ought to overwhelm us--something of the gratitude that surely ought to fill our hearts. I refer, of